

Chapter 66-3

Not long after, Liang Shi received a video call from Liang Xinhe.

The two chatted for a bit, mainly asking if Ling Dang was being good. But when they looked, Ling Dang was already asleep, not missing her mom and dad at all. Liang Xinhe couldn't help but say, "Little heartless one."

Liang Shi smiled helplessly.

Liang Xinhe reminded her to go to bed early, and only at the end did she ask: "After you drop Ling Dang off tomorrow, stay at home for dinner with your sister-in-law¹."

Liang Shi's smile froze, and she said somewhat awkwardly: "If we're there, won't it be awkward to eat?"

"What's awkward about it?" Liang Xinhe frowned, speaking carelessly: "Do you still have the surname Liang or not?"

Liang Shi: "The way you put it, I can't change my surname in such a short time."

"Then that's settled." Liang Xinhe said: "Bring Qingzhu along too. It's our own home anyway, what's wrong with having a meal?"

Liang Shi couldn't refuse anymore and had to agree. "Alright."

After she finished the call with Liang Xinhe, Xu Qingzhu received a call from Mother Xu, speaking in low tones about who knows what.

Xu Qingzhu was afraid of disturbing Ling Dang's sleep, so she went out to take the call.

She didn't return until much later.

Meanwhile, Liang Shi sat at the head of the bed in a daze, contemplating whether to go downstairs to sleep or stay here.

Before she could think of an answer, Xu Qingzhu returned to the room. She removed her hair tie, letting her hair fall loose, and took off her outer cardigan, wearing only a slip dress.

Her arms didn't have an ounce of excess flesh, her collarbones were delicate, and the loose slip dress didn't make her look excessively thin.

Liang Shi only glanced once before making her decision: go downstairs.

She didn't dare take the blanket or pillow, afraid that this mischievous little one would wake up in the middle of the night and wail. She just planned to go downstairs and get new ones to make do.

But before she could leave, Xu Qingzhu asked: "Where are you going?"

"Going downstairs to sleep." Liang Shi answered.

Xu Qingzhu got into bed, covered herself with the blanket, and leaned against the headboard. Taking a book from the drawer, she was casually flipping through pages when her hand suddenly paused. "What if Ling Dang wakes up in the middle of the night?"

"Just say I'm in the bathroom." Liang Shi said: "I'll come back up tomorrow morning."

"There's no need to be so troublesome." Xu Qingzhu didn't mind. "Just sleep over there. Otherwise, if Ling Dang discovers it, she'll ask all sorts of questions."

Liang Shi: "....."

It was indeed more convenient to sleep upstairs.

Liang Shi's heart swayed precariously on the scales.

In the end, she chose to compromise.

She turned off the main light in the room, leaving only the two dim, amber lamps by the bed.

The room's ambiance immediately became much more elegant.

Her long-sleeved pajamas seemed extremely conservative at this moment. As soon as she got into bed, Ling Dang rolled over and burrowed into her arms, as if sensing the warmth.

Xu Qingzhu was surprised, then said: "She seems to especially like you."

"A bit." Liang Shi was afraid of waking Ling Dang, so she lowered her voice: "Little clingy spirit."

"All little kids are like this." Xu Qingzhu glanced at Ling Dang. Before bed, Xu Qingzhu had helped her untie her hair, but this little girl's sleeping posture wasn't very good, and now her hair was plastered all over her face, which looked uncomfortable.

She simply found a small hair tie and smoothed out her hair, tying it in a very loose ponytail that wouldn't pull on her scalp or plaster hair on her face.

Liang Shi suddenly thought of something from during the day and sighed: "You can only have one child."

"Why?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

"Too many will fight." Liang Shi told her about Ling Dang and Rainbow's incident. After finishing, she sighed: "And that was with Rainbow being sensible. Otherwise, they would definitely have pulled each other's hair bows."

"That's just how little kids are." Xu Qingzhu said: "Don't look at how they're fighting now—they'll make up in a bit and won't even remember. It's the adults who have to be the judge. You always have to arbitrate for them, right?"

"No need." Xu Qingzhu shrugged. "The best method is to let them handle it themselves. If they like to fight, let them fight—whoever wins is fine. Anyway, before long, when no one will play with them, they'll naturally make up on their own. Adults shouldn't interfere in children's matters."

Liang Shi was puzzled. "It can be like that?"

"That's how it should be." Xu Qingzhu said matter-of-factly: "Otherwise, if your daughter gets into a fight with another kid at kindergarten later, are you going to help her fight too?"

Liang Shi: "....."

She said awkwardly, "Well, I wouldn't do that."

"You might not be sure you can hold back." Xu Qingzhu chuckled. "By then, you'll go join your daughter and tear off other kids' hair bows."

"How is that possible?" Liang Shi said helplessly. "Teacher Xu, am I that childish in your heart?"

"No, no, no." Xu Qingzhu denied three times in a row, but paused before saying: "You're just too indulgent with little kids."

Liang Shi: "....."

After a while, Ling Dang burrowed into her arms, soft and warm, a tiny little bundle.

Liang Shi looked at Xu Qingzhu and sighed helplessly, muttering: "With such a small little kid, of course you have to dote on them."

Who wouldn't be smitten with this?

Xu Qingzhu just smiled without speaking, opening her book to read.

Xu Qingzhu under the amber lamplight was also very beautiful. She had draped a jacket over herself, and sitting there reading, she appeared serene and refined.

Liang Shi looked sideways, and before she knew it, her mind had wandered.

Footnotes:

¹ Sister-in-law (妹妻): Literally "younger sister's wife" or "younger wife," in this context referring to Xu Qingzhu as Liang Shi's wife/partner. The term reflects the familial relationship structure where Liang Shi would be considered part of the family, and Xu Qingzhu would be addressed accordingly by other family members.